



TRAINING PROGRAMME

Technical & Academic Writing

Find, cite and write clearly, with honest sources and useful figures

18 HOURS

FOR Students, researchers and engineers who write reports and papers



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Overview

This free course helps participants write technical and academic documents that are clear, honest and well sourced. They manage references with Zotero, read and summarise papers, learn the rules of publication ethics and how to avoid plagiarism, then apply the principles of clear, precise and concise writing, use the passive voice deliberately, and design figures that support the text. The course closes with a final project in which each participant writes a short paper section with citations and a figure and reviews a peer's work.

At a glance

#	PHASE	FOCUS	HOURS
01	Sources & Ethics	Zotero, reading and summarising papers, publication ethics, plagiarism	6 h
02	Writing & Figures	Clarity, precision, concision, voice and style, figures	6 h
03	Final Project	A short paper section, written and peer-reviewed	3 h
	Buffer	Catch-up, revision, extra lab time	3 h
Total			18 h

Key facts

AUDIENCE	Students, researchers and engineers who write reports and papers
PREREQUISITES	None. Participants bring a writing project of their own if they have one
DURATION	18 h: 15 h of chapters + 3 h buffer
FORMAT	Free course: short lectures, each followed by writing exercises and peer feedback
LAB ENVIRONMENT	One laptop per participant with Zotero 7 and its word-processor plugin, a word processor, a spreadsheet or Python (Matplotlib); no account or cost
ASSESSMENT	Exercises reviewed in each phase and a final paper section reviewed by a peer; certificate of completion for participants who complete both
OUTCOME	Participants can manage and cite sources with Zotero, summarise papers, avoid plagiarism, and write clear sections with effective figures

PHASE 01

6 H

Sources & Ethics

Participants build a reference library in Zotero and cite from it, learn to read and summarise papers efficiently, and study publication ethics and how to avoid plagiarism. Validated exercise: a one-page summary of a paper with correctly generated citations.

#	CHAPTER	CONTENT	FORMAT	HOURS
1.1	Reference Management	Zotero: installation, library, citations, exercise	Lecture + Lab	3 h
1.2	Reading & Summarising	Summarising papers	Lecture + Workshop	1.5 h
1.3	Ethics	Publication ethics, avoiding plagiarism	Lecture + Workshop	1.5 h

PHASE 02

6 H

Writing & Figures

Participants apply the rules of academic writing for clarity, precision and concision, choose between active and passive voice on purpose, and design figures that make one point each. Validated exercise: a paragraph rewritten for clarity and a figure redesigned from a cluttered original.

#	CHAPTER	CONTENT	FORMAT	HOURS
2.1	Writing Rules	Academic writing rules; clarity, precision, concision	Lecture + Workshop	3 h
2.2	Style	Passive voice and style	Lecture + Workshop	1.5 h
2.3	Data Visualisation	Essentials for papers	Lecture + Workshop	1.5 h

PHASE 03

3 H

Final Project

Each participant writes a short section of a paper or report, reusing the course exercises, and reviews a peer's section.

#	CHAPTER	CONTENT	FORMAT	HOURS
3.1	Write	A short paper section with Zotero citations and a figure	Project	1.5 h
3.2	Peer Review	Review a peer's section, revise one's own; feedback	Project	1.5 h

FINAL PROJECT

Paper Section with Peer Review

A short paper or report section with citations managed in Zotero and one figure, reviewed by a peer and revised.

STACK Zotero 7 with its word-processor plugin, a word processor, a spreadsheet or Python (Matplotlib)

DELIVERABLE Revised section, peer-review notes